# Economic Insights

Feb 04, 2026

## Five things that could derail the ECB

At its meeting this week, the ECB is set to stay stable in turbulent times.

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## Team Italy: An economic performance worthy of a gold medal?

Italy approaches the Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026 with a notably stronger macroeconomic backdrop, underpinned by post-pandemic resilience in output, employment and trade, and an improved fiscal stance.

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Feb 02, 2026

## A new decade high for major insolvencies driven by services, retail and construction

Business insolvencies ended 2025 with an upside trend in most countries, despite already high levels.

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## market opportunities and liquidity risks

The major sell-off on the long end of the Japanese sovereign yield curve is not a “Truss moment” but signals a bumpy final stage of Japan’s monetary normalization.

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## fragmented world: Navigating Collection Complexity

Recovering commercial debt could become even more of a challenge as business insolvencies remain high in most countries while global fragmentation rises amid a reconfiguration of the trading system, volatile protectionism, geopolitical uncertainties and higher digital risk.

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## export gains in a fragmented world

After signing the EU–Mercosur agreement on 17 January, the EU is looking to speed up its trade policy momentum to diversify trade structures in a more fragmented global economy.

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Jan 23, 2026

## Eyes back on the Fed (and on interventionist financial policies)

We continue to expect only one rate cut (-25bps to 3.50%) from the Fed this year. This cut is now expected in June instead of March, which confirms a normalization of monetary policy to neutral settings. A May surprise (-50bps)

Jan 20, 2026

## The heat is on: Unlocking Germany’s heat-pump potential

Germany’s path to net-zero runs through its homes and buildings.

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Jan 16, 2026

## Geopolitics heats up from Venezuela, to Greenland to Iran, but investors shrug. For how long?

2026 started off on a strong footing with geopolitics taking on center stage, again.

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